
GRANDMA'S
Stevie
BOOK

A PERSONALIZED STORYBOOK

GRANDMA'S STEVIE BOOK

RAMBLEBOOK

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ABOUT THIS DRAFT

Grandma's Stevie Book is a working draft, produced with RambleBook from an original story idea. It is complete as a story — beginning, middle, and end, in 6 chapters — and deliberately unfinished as a book. Chapter One is written at full weight; the chapters that follow are leaner, the way first drafts are: the bones and the heartbeat, waiting for a writer's second pass. Writing is rewriting. This is the draft you rewrite from.

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Chapter 1

A Cookie for the Moon

Stevie hurried to the window with a cookie in one hand and his favorite blanket in the other.

The blanket dragged behind him. It brushed a chair leg, swept over his sister's toes, and arrived in a heap.

"Special delivery," said Stevie.

He held the cookie up to the moon.

The moon did not take it.

Stevie moved it a little to the left.

Still nothing.

"Maybe it likes the other side," he said. He turned the cookie around.

His sister leaned beside him. "That is a very long delivery."

"It can come closer."

Stevie waited. He was six. He knew how to wait.

He waited three whole seconds.

Then he took a bite.

"Delivery charge," he explained.



Grandma set his milk on the table. Cookies and milk came before bed every night. No exceptions. Apparently, not even for moon business.

Stevie pressed his nose against the cool window.

His sister pressed hers beside it.

"Steedy Stevie Funny Nose," she said softly.

She had made up that name at bedtime, and it had stuck. Stevie liked how it sounded when she said it, as if she were announcing someone who had just arrived carrying something excellent.

He lifted his cookie.

"Funny nose and proud of it."

Grandma laughed. His sister's breath made a small cloudy patch on the glass.

Stevie drew a circle in it with one finger.

"A plate!" he said.

"But still no way to pass the cookie through."

Stevie looked beyond their reflections. The backyard lay under the moon, with plenty of room for a visitor.

"What if we made it somewhere to sit?"

His sister looked out too.

“A moon seat?”

“And an invitation.”

Stevie gathered his blanket under his chin. He would need it for sleeping now, and for important work tomorrow.

This was a much better plan.

The cookie would not have to travel alone.

Chapter 2

A Seat for a Visitor

Stevie pushed a backyard chair across the grass the next evening.

His sister caught the other side before it tipped.

“Here?” she asked.

Stevie looked up. The moon hung pale above the fence.

“Here. It needs a good view of us.”

He dragged his favorite blanket over and spread it across the seat. One corner dangled down. He tucked it in, then patted the middle.

A moon should not have to sit on a hard chair.



His sister brought two cushions for their own seats. Then she held up the invitation they had made at the table.

WELCOME, MOON.

Stevie had drawn the chair underneath, with an arrow pointing to it.

“So it knows which one,” he explained.

They leaned the invitation against the chair back. His sister looped paper decorations along the fence. There were stars, circles, and one moon with a rather square chin.

“That one looks like it’s chewing,” Stevie said.

“Perhaps it’s practicing for supper.”

Stevie stepped back to check everything.

The chair was soft. The invitation was straight.

But a branch stretched right across the moon.

“It can’t see the sign.”

He shifted the invitation left.

The branch stayed in the way.

He shifted it right.

Still leaves.

His sister crouched beside him. “The moon is a long way past that tree.”

“Yes, but the tree is very close to our invitation.”

They moved the guest chair a little. Stevie checked the sky, then moved it back.

At last he put the invitation on the grass in front.

“There. No chair back blocking it, anyway.”

He smoothed his blanket once more. It felt strange to leave his sleeping softness outside, even for such an important guest.

A leaf fluttered above him.

Stevie pointed at the branch.

“You can come too,” he told it, “but you’ll have to stop waving.”

Chapter 3

The Wind Rearranges Everything

A gust lifted the invitation and slapped it flat against Stevie's shoe.

He bent to rescue it.

Behind him, the paper stars began to dance.

One flipped over the fence string. Another spun around its own tape. The square-chinned moon broke free and sailed straight at Stevie.

Plop.

It covered his nose.

His sister reached for it, but Stevie stood very still.

"I've caught the moon," he said through the paper.



She peeled it away.

He wriggled his nose.

“Funny nose and proud of it.”

They both laughed. Then three more stars escaped.

“Catch those!” his sister called.

Stevie chased a star across the grass. It stopped beside a flowerpot, trembled, and scooted away just as he reached down.

“This one has running feet!”

He caught it with both hands.

His sister gathered the loose string while Stevie collected paper circles. He tucked the invitation beneath a cushion so it could not fly again.

Grandma came to the back door.

“Shall I take the cushions inside?”

“Yes, please,” his sister said. “The decorations are trying to leave.”

Grandma lifted the cushions into her arms. One corner of fabric hung beneath them, but Stevie was watching a star roll under the guest chair.

He knelt and picked it up.

At last the fence was bare. The papers were stacked. His sister carried the invitation inside and set it on the hall table.

Stevie went back for his blanket.

The guest chair was empty.

He looked underneath.

Only grass.

He checked behind the chair, then touched the seat as if the blanket might have become too flat to see.

“Did you take it?” he asked his sister.

“No.”

Stevie looked toward the darkening fence.

The wind had taken the papers everywhere.

He held the last star tightly.

“Then where did my blanket go?”

Chapter 4

Here, Blanket!

Stevie lifted the corner of the rug.

His sister looked underneath with him.

No blanket.

Grandma shut the back door gently. “We’ll look together.”

Bedtime was getting closer. Stevie could feel it in his tired knees. Usually, by now, his blanket would be trailing behind him or tucked beneath his chin.

He could not imagine going to bed without it.

“Here, blanket,” his sister called softly.

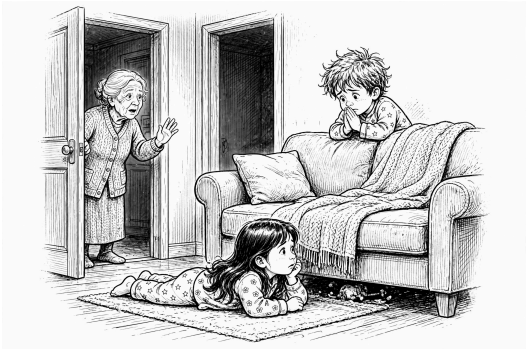
Stevie looked at her.

“That’s how you call a dog.”

“Well, yours follows you everywhere.”

That was true.

“Here, blanket!” he called.



Grandma opened the sitting-room door. “Has anybody seen a blanket with no ears and a very long tail?”

Stevie almost smiled.

They searched behind the curtains. His sister looked under the table. Grandma checked beside the chair where Stevie sometimes made a nest.

Stevie peered behind the sofa.

“Come on,” he whispered. “It’s nearly bedtime.”

His sister lay flat on her stomach to look underneath.

“Dust,” she reported. “One paper scrap. No blanket.”

“Maybe it’s hiding,” Stevie said.

“Then we’ll find its hiding place,” Grandma answered.

They checked his bed, though he knew he had taken the blanket outside. They checked the doorway, where it sometimes caught and stretched behind him until he went back to free it.

Still nothing.

Stevie stood in the sitting room and pressed his hands together. They felt empty without a soft corner to rub.

His sister came beside him.

"We haven't finished looking."

Something small lay near his foot.

A leaf.

He picked it up by its stem.

There were no trees in the sitting room.

Stevie looked at the basket where Grandma had put the backyard cushions. A bit of grass clung to the top one.

He moved closer.

If the leaf had come inside with the cushions, perhaps something else had come with them.

Chapter 5

The Cape Comes Back

Stevie pulled the top cushion from the basket.

He set it on the floor.

Then he lifted the second cushion.

A familiar soft corner poked out beneath it.

"Blanket!"

He tugged carefully. Out came a fold, then another, then the whole rumpled blanket.

Stevie gathered it against his face.

It smelled like his blanket, with a little backyard added.

Grandma crouched beside the basket.

"I must have scooped it up with the cushions. I'm sorry, Stevie."

"You brought it inside."

"I did. I just didn't know I had a passenger."

His sister patted the empty basket. "A very quiet passenger."

Stevie wrapped the blanket around his shoulders. His hands had their corners back. His chest felt loose again.

For a moment, he simply stood there.

Then he remembered the invitation.

“It’s on the hall table,” his sister said. “We could put it by the backyard window.”

“One more try,” Stevie said.

Beyond the sitting-room doorway, the hallway was dark. At the far end, a little light from another room touched the table.

Stevie held his blanket under his chin.

Grandma and his sister were right behind him, putting the cushions away.

“I’ll get it,” he said.

He stepped into the hallway alone.

The floor felt cool beneath his feet. He could hear Grandma settling the basket and his sister folding the cushion covers straight.

Stevie took another step.

His blanket slipped behind his shoulders.

He spread his arms a little, and it became a cape.



At the table, he picked up the invitation by both corners. Then he turned and walked back, his recovered blanket cape flying behind him.

His sister looked up.

"Special delivery?"

Stevie held out the paper.

"This time," he said, "the moon can read it through the window."

Chapter 6

Everybody Gets a Cookie

Stevie propped the invitation against the backyard window.

His sister steadied it while he adjusted the bottom edge.

Outside, the guest chair waited on the grass. Inside, Stevie settled beside Grandma with his blanket wrapped around him.

This was the proper place for the blanket tonight.

Grandma passed him a cookie and set his milk within reach.

Cookies and milk before bed. No exceptions.

His sister sat on his other side.

“Do you think the moon saw our chair?” she asked.

Stevie looked out.

The moon had moved beyond the troublesome branch. It shone above the yard, round and bright, with nothing leafy across its face.

“It can see it now.”



He lifted his cookie toward the glass, but only for a moment.

Then he took a bite.

“Still charging for delivery?” his sister asked.

“Mm-hmm.”

Grandma brushed a crumb from her lap. “A sensible business.”

Stevie leaned closer to the window. His reflection leaned closer too.

There was his blanket. There was his cookie.

And there was his nose, floating right beside the moon.

He turned his head one way, then the other. The moon and his reflection made a very odd pair.

“Funny nose and proud of it.”

His sister laughed and leaned in until her reflection joined his. Grandma appeared behind them, smiling.

Now the window held all three of them and the moon.

Stevie offered his sister a cookie from the plate. Then he made sure Grandma had one too.

Outside, the chair stayed empty.

It did not look lonely anymore. It looked ready.

“Should we bring it in?” Grandma asked.

Stevie tucked his blanket beneath his chin and thought about morning.

“Leave it for the sunshine.”

His sister glanced at the paper invitation.

“We’ll need a different sign.”

Stevie finished his milk.

“This one can just say, ‘Your turn.’”

ABOUT THE AUTHOR

RambleBook makes storybooks about the people you love, from the details only you know.

A PERSONALIZED STORYBOOK

A storybook to keep & share

Stevie is 6 years old — curious, brave, funny all the way through. A keepsake storybook about Stevie, made for Grandma to keep, to show, and to read aloud.